

Joshua Lawson

Ph.D. Candidate

Department of Finance, University of Tennessee, Knoxville

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Research Interests

Asset pricing; price impact of retail demand; portfolio choice; empirical market microstructure; machine learning in finance.

Education

Ph.D. in Finance

Aug. 2024–May 2027

University of Tennessee, Knoxville

Department of Finance. Expected completion: May 2027.

Graduate Study in Finance

Aug. 2021–May 2024

University of Rochester

Simon Business School.

M.S. in Mathematics, Applied Track

May 2021

SUNY–Buffalo

GPA: 3.6/4.0. Relevant coursework: Numerical Analysis I/II, Methods of Applied Mathematics I/II, Stochastic Processes, Real Analysis, Measure Theory, Nonlinear Dynamics.

M.S. in Quantitative Finance

Dec. 2020

SUNY–Buffalo

GPA: 4.0/4.0. Relevant coursework: Quantitative Methods for Finance, Portfolio Theory, Financial Modeling in R.

Publications

- Md Rafayet Alam, Md Abdur Rahman Forhad, Mohammed Syedul Islam, and Joshua Lawson. “Crude Oil Futures Prices and Foreign Exchange Markets.” *Applied Economics*, 2023.
- Joshua Lawson, Md Rafayet Alam, and Xiaoli L. Etienne. “Speculation and Food-Grain Commodities.” *Applied Economics*, 2021.

Working Papers

- “The Equilibrium Price Impact of Household Demand.” Job market paper.
- “Arbitrage Thresholds and Price Discovery in Dual-Class Equity.” Draft available upon request.
- “Expected Growth and Average Utility: A Microeconomic Axiomatization of Ergodicity Economics.” Draft available upon request.

Presentations and Seminars

- FMA Doctoral Student Consortium, Tampa, FL, Oct. 2026. Selected presenter, “The Equilibrium Price Impact of Household Demand.”
- Brown Bag Seminar, University of Rochester, 2022, 2023, 2024.
- Brown Bag Seminar, University of Tennessee, 2024, 2026.

Conferences and Workshops

- Santa Fe Institute, Spring 2024.
- London Mathematical Laboratory, Fall 2024.

Teaching Experience

Investment and Portfolio Management (FINC 425)

Spring 2026; Fall 2026

Instructor, University of Tennessee, Knoxville

Financial Derivatives (MGF 635)

Spring 2021

Instructor, SUNY–Buffalo

Graduate level.

Financial Derivatives (MGF 435)

Spring 2021

Instructor, SUNY–Buffalo

Undergraduate level.

Teaching Assistant and Tutor

Sep. 2019–Dec. 2020

SUNY–Buffalo

Derivative Securities, Corporate Finance, Equity Research, Biostatistics, Calculus I/II/III, Linear Algebra, Probability Theory.

Awards and Honors

- Ed Nissan Best Undergraduate Paper Award, 2019.

Service

- Quantitative Portfolio Construction with Asset Pricing and Python – an 8 week applied mini-seminar covering arbitrage pricing theory and models of the stochastic discount factor, Summer 2026.

Software and Computing

Mu Hat: A comprehensive Python package that replicates the canon of empirical asset pricing.

References

Available upon request.